

15 March 2026

Admissions Committee
Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Cambridge, MA 02139
United States

Re: Recommendation for Ms. Wei Zhang (张薇)

Dear Members of the Committee,

I am Professor Li Ming, Chair of the Institute of Intelligent Systems at Harbin Institute of Technology. I write in the strongest terms to recommend Ms. Wei Zhang for admission to your doctoral program. I have supervised Wei since 2023 as her undergraduate thesis advisor and as the principal investigator of the NSFC project on scientific surrogate calibration in which she is a student researcher.

Wei's work sits at the intersection of scientific machine learning and uncertainty quantification. In her thesis she designed a residual-score calibration procedure for frozen PDE emulators. The method estimates a monotone transport map on a small labeled holdout set and produces prediction intervals with near-nominal coverage on Burgers, Darcy, and reaction-diffusion benchmarks. A workshop paper based on this study was accepted at a national AI-for-science symposium; Wei was first author and presented the poster.

Beyond the technical results, Wei is unusually careful. She independently reproduced two baseline solvers, wrote a documented Python package for the calibration maps, and mentored two junior students through their first conference abstracts. In group meetings she is the person who notices when a coverage claim is being overstated.

I rank Wei in the top 3% of undergraduates I have taught in the last decade. She has the mathematical maturity, experimental discipline, and scientific taste to thrive in a competitive Ph.D. program. I recommend her without reservation. Please contact me if I can provide any further information.

Sincerely,

Prof. Li Ming

Professor and Institute Chair

School of Computer Science and Technology

Harbin Institute of Technology

liming@hit.edu.cn +86-451-8641-3300

Enclosures: curriculum vitae; unofficial transcript; list of publications.